Northwind Health Insurance - Policy Document NH-2026-01

Policy Number: NH-2026-01 (Individual Health Cover, Silver Plan)

Effective date: 1 January 2026. Document version 3.2.

This document sets out the terms, conditions, exclusions and underwriting rules that apply to your policy. Please read it carefully and keep it in a safe place.

1. Definitions

Insured person means the person named in the policy schedule.

Pre-existing condition means any illness, injury or symptom for which the insured person received advice, diagnosis or treatment in the 24 months before the effective date.

Underwriting decision means the outcome of our assessment of an application: Accept, Accept with Loading, Accept with Exclusion, Postpone or Decline.

Loading means an additional percentage applied to the standard premium to reflect higher risk.

2. Scope of Cover

This policy covers inpatient hospital treatment, day-case surgery, specialist consultations and diagnostic tests when medically necessary and referred by a registered physician.

Outpatient benefits are limited to GBP 1,500 per policy year. Mental health cover is limited to 20 outpatient sessions per policy year.

Cover is subject to the exclusions in Section 8 and the underwriting decision recorded in Section 4.

3. Underwriting Process

Every application is assessed using the health declaration, medical history, age, BMI, occupation and lifestyle information provided by the applicant.

Applicants aged 18-49 with no declared conditions and BMI between 18.5 and 30 are normally accepted at standard terms without a medical examination.

Applicants aged 50 or over, or with any declared condition, are referred to a senior underwriter and may be asked for a GP report.

Non-disclosure of material facts may result in the policy being voided and claims being declined.

4. Underwriting Decision Matrix

The following table summarises standard underwriting decisions by risk factor.

Risk factor	Condition	Decision	Loading / Term
Age	18-34	Accept	None
Age	35-49	Accept	+10%
Age	50-64	Accept with Loading	+25%
Age	65+	Refer to senior underwriter	Case by case
BMI	18.5 - 29.9	Accept	None
BMI	30 - 34.9	Accept with Loading	+15%
BMI	35 - 39.9	Accept with Loading	+30%
BMI	40+	Postpone	Re-apply after 6 months
Smoker	Current smoker	Accept with Loading	+20%
Smoker	Quit under 12 months	Accept with Loading	+10%

5. Medical Conditions - Underwriting Outcomes

The table below shows the usual outcome for commonly declared conditions.

Condition	Details	Decision
Hypertension	Controlled with medication, readings under 140/90	Accept with Loading +15%
Hypertension	Uncontrolled or readings over 160/100	Postpone
Type 2 diabetes	HbA1c under 7.5%, no complications	Accept with Loading +40%
Type 2 diabetes	With complications (kidney, eye, nerve)	Decline
Asthma	Mild, no hospital admission in 24 months	Accept
Asthma	Hospital admission in last 24 months	Accept with Exclusion (respiratory)
Back pain	Single episode, resolved over 12 months ago	Accept
Back pain	Recurring or under treatment	Accept with Exclusion (spine)
Cancer	In remission less than 5 years	Decline
Cancer	In remission 5 years or more	Refer to senior underwriter

6. Mental Health Underwriting

Applicants declaring anxiety or depression are assessed as follows: a single episode resolved more than 24 months ago is accepted at standard terms; an episode within 24 months is accepted with a mental health exclusion for 24 months.

Any history of hospital admission for a mental health condition, or any self-harm, results in a Decline unless a specialist report supports a lower risk assessment.

7. Occupation and Lifestyle

Occupations are grouped into three classes. Class 1 (office-based) is accepted at standard terms. Class 2 (light manual) carries a loading of +5%. Class 3 (heavy manual, offshore, working at height) carries a loading of +15%.

Hazardous pursuits such as scuba diving below 30 metres, mountaineering above 4,000 metres and motor racing are excluded from cover unless specifically agreed in writing.

Applicants who consume more than 35 units of alcohol per week are referred to a senior underwriter.

8. General Exclusions

The following are not covered under this policy:

(a) Cosmetic or aesthetic surgery unless required after an accident or cancer treatment.

(b) Fertility treatment, including IVF.

(c) Pregnancy and childbirth, except for complications of pregnancy.

(d) Treatment of drug or alcohol dependency.

(e) Pre-existing conditions that are subject to a policy exclusion recorded in Section 4 or 5.

(f) Treatment received outside the United Kingdom, unless it is emergency treatment during travel of less than 30 days.

(g) Experimental or unproven treatments, and treatments not recognised by NICE.

9. Waiting Periods

Cover for inpatient treatment begins after a 14-day waiting period from the effective date, except where treatment is required following an accident.

Cover for specialist outpatient consultations begins after 30 days. Cover for dental and optical benefits begins after 6 months.

10. Premiums, Loadings and Renewal

The standard annual premium is GBP 1,200 for a 30-year-old non-smoker. Loadings from Sections 4 to 7 are added together and applied to the standard premium.

Example: a 52-year-old smoker with a BMI of 32 would have loadings of 25% + 20% + 15% = 60% applied.

Premiums are reviewed annually. Underwriting decisions made at inception are not revisited at renewal unless a material fact was not disclosed.

11. Claims Procedure

Contact our claims team before starting treatment. Pre-authorisation is required for all inpatient treatment and for diagnostic scans such as MRI and CT.

Claims must be submitted within 6 months of the treatment date. We aim to settle valid claims within 10 working days of receiving all documents.

If a claim relates to a condition that was declared at underwriting with an exclusion, it will be declined.

12. Appeals and Review of Underwriting Decisions

You may request a review of any underwriting decision within 30 days of receiving it. Provide any additional medical evidence, such as a specialist report or recent test results.

A Postpone decision may be reviewed after the period stated in the decision. A Decline decision may be reviewed after 12 months, or sooner if there has been a significant change in health.

Reviews are carried out by a senior underwriter who was not involved in the original decision.

13. Contact and Complaints

Northwind Health Insurance, 1 Example Street, London. Customer service: 0800 000 0000.

If you are not satisfied with our final response to a complaint you may refer it to the Financial Ombudsman Service. This document is a fictional sample created for testing purposes only.